LENA VARGA-HOLM

Senior Data Engineer

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PROFILE

Data engineer with 9 years of experience building batch and streaming data platforms for e-commerce and payments. I build and operate reusable, well-tested batch and streaming platforms, with a focus on data contracts, reliable warehouses, and clear interfaces for analysts and product teams.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Engineer - Lukovac Freight Hub d.o.o. (logistics marketplace), Rijeka *03/2022 - present*

- Own the ingestion layer of the company data platform: ~140 Airflow DAGs loading from Postgres, MySQL, Salesforce and 3rd-party APIs into Snowflake.
- Moved transformation logic from stored procedures to dbt (420+ models, tests on every model); nightly run time down from 5h10 to 1h50.
- Introduced data contracts between product teams and the data team (JSON Schema + CI checks), cutting broken-pipeline incidents from ~9/month to ~2/month.
- Built a Kafka-based shipment-tracking pipeline using Kafka Connect and Snowpipe Streaming, processing approximately 30M events/day with under 2-minute p95 end-to-end latency; added a dead-letter topic and replay tooling for safe reprocessing.
- Reduced Snowflake costs from approximately $38K/month to $24K/month through warehouse sizing, auto-suspend, and removal of unused tables; participated in a one-week-in-six data-platform on-call rotation.
- Replaced hourly full-table extracts from Postgres with Debezium CDC into Kafka, reducing replica CPU during loads from approximately 70% to 25%.
- Mentor two mid-level data engineers; run the weekly data platform office hours.

Data Engineer - Kovalent Pay (payments startup), Zagreb *09/2019 - 02/2022*

- Built PySpark batch jobs on AWS EMR to reconcile bank settlement files with internal ledgers, processing approximately 1.2 TB/day from S3 and reducing finance-team manual reconciliation from about 3 days to 4 hours per month-end.
- Designed the Redshift warehouse schema (star schema, 30+ fact/dimension tables) used by finance and risk.
- Set up data quality checks with Great Expectations on critical finance tables.
- Wrote internal Python library for S3/Glue catalog access used by 4 teams.

Junior Data Engineer / BI Developer - Adria Retail Group, Split *06/2017 - 08/2019*

- Maintained SSIS packages and T-SQL ETL into an on-prem SQL Server warehouse.
- Built Power BI reports for store operations (40+ stores).
- Migrated 60 nightly SSIS jobs to Python scripts scheduled with cron.

EDUCATION

MSc Computer Science (Data Science track) - Northgate Technical University, 2017
Thesis: Incremental materialized views for analytical queries

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Data Engineer – Associate (May 2024)

OPEN-SOURCE & COMMUNITY

Open-source contribution: fixed a pagination bug and added tests to a community Airflow provider package; 2 pull requests merged (2023).
Speaker, 'Data contracts without the hype,' regional data meetup (2024)
SQL mentor, local Women in Tech meetup, approximately 4 evenings/year since 2021.

SKILLS

Languages: Python, SQL, Bash
Data: Airflow, dbt, Spark (PySpark), Kafka, Kafka Connect, Snowflake, Redshift, PostgreSQL, Great Expectations, Debezium, CDC, Snowpipe Streaming, Data contracts
Cloud & infra: AWS (S3, EMR, Glue, Lambda, IAM), Docker, Terraform (basic), GitHub Actions, AWS MSK, pytest
BI: Power BI, Looker (basic)

LANGUAGES

Croatian (native), English (C1), German (B1)